

- ▶ **Profile:** Your Xbox Live profile consists of the Gamertag, Gamer Zone, Gamer Picture, Motto, Avatar, Name, Bio, Location and privacy settings information described before.
- ▶ **Rep:** This is your reputation score, on a scale of one to five. Every Xbox Live member starts at three and your rep can go up or down from there based on your experience (the more you play, the higher the rep) and whether any other gamers complain about you online (the more you misbehave, the more people complain, and the more your rep declines).
- ▶ **Gamerscore:** Each Xbox Live game can assign gamer points to individual achievements, as we'll soon discuss. These points are applied to your Gamerscore, which starts at zero. The higher your Gamerscore, the more experienced you are, generally speaking, though many hardcore gamers only play in multi-player matches that don't provide multi-player achievements and thus might have deceptively low Gamerscores.
- ▶ **Gamercard:** Your Xbox Live Gamercard combines your Gamertag, Gamer Picture, Rep, Gamerscore and Gamer Zone into a single, easily viewable overview of your Xbox Live account or gamer persona.
- ▶ **Messages:** Using an email-like system, Xbox Live members can message each other using text, audio and video chat. These messages aren't ever broadcast via normal email systems (via the email associated with your Windows Live ID), but you can view and respond to them on the Xbox 360 and, for text messages, via the Zune PC software as well.
- ▶ **Friends list:** As with Facebook and other social networks, you can "friend" other people online, send and receive friend requests, see what your friends are doing online in real time, send messages to friends and more. The Xbox Live Friends list is sorted by online status so that online friends are listed first.
- ▶ **Players list:** Xbox Live also tracks the players you've most recently played against so you can find them again later and request a rematch, send feedback (positive or negative) or send a friend request.
- ▶ **Games list:** Xbox Live also tracks the games you've most recently played, as well as the achievements you've most recently earned, including all of the achievements earned in each played game. Friends can examine your account to see which games you've played and which achievements you've earned, and compare them to their own results.

If there's a problem with Xbox Live accounts, there's no escaping the fact that much of the profile and Gamercard type information can only be edited, at this time, from an Xbox 360 console. So even though you can log on to xbox-